

Qingai (Sunny) Xu

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SUMMARY

Researcher and data analyst with 4+ years of experience leading quantitative and qualitative research on career and technical education (CTE) and workforce development. Skilled in designing data collection and analysis strategies, managing cross-functional research teams and projects, and translating findings into clear, actionable recommendations for institutional leadership and non-technical audiences. Proficient in Python, R, SQL, Stata, and Power BI.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

San Diego Community College District (SDCCD)

San Diego, CA

Project Manager & Career and Technical Education (CTE) Research Expert

September 2024 - Present

- Lead districtwide CTE research and Perkins V compliance reporting across four community colleges, framing federally mandated needs assessments as data-driven planning tools rather than compliance exercises.
- Coordinating researchers and college leadership to align analytical deliverables with institutional decision-making.
- Build data strategies, reporting frameworks, and Power BI dashboards integrating administrative and labor-market data to identify performance gaps and inform program improvement.
- Develop standard operating procedures and present findings to leadership across the district.

San Diego & Imperial Center of Excellence for Labor Market Research (COE)

San Diego, CA

Regional Career and Technical Education (CTE) Research Expert

April 2023 - August 2024

- Developed 8+ interactive dashboards integrating labor market, education, demographic, and program data (Python, SQL, Power BI) to support workforce planning and decision-making.
- Delivered Python and data-analysis training to 30+ researchers, building organizational research capacity and data literacy
- Conducted labor market research and produced local labor market information reports; compiled and cleaned data for 30,000+ San Diego community college programs for the Strong Workforce Program database.

UC San Diego, School of Global Policy and Strategy

San Diego, CA

Graduate Research Assistant / Staff Research Associate

April 2023 - January 2024

- Built automated data collection and processing pipelines (Python) and cleaned/validated large-scale datasets (200K+ records) to support policy research and reporting.

Regression Analysis in R Tutor & GIS and Spatial Data Analysis Teaching Assistant

September 2022 - March 2023

- Tutored 30 graduate students with no prior data experience in regression analysis (R)
- Served as teaching assistant for a 100-student graduate course in GIS and spatial data analysis (QGIS, R)

American Enterprise Institute (AEI)

Washington, DC

Data Analysis Intern, Education Policy Team

June 2022 - August 2022

- Applied data analysis and machine learning techniques and web-scraping data to support education policy research projects

EDUCATION

Master of Public Policy — UC San Diego, School of Global Policy and Strategy

Relevant coursework: Applied Data Analysis & Statistical Decision Making; Data Science Approaches to Spatial Analysis

B.S. Applied Mathematics & B.A. Economics – Public Policy (Double Major) — UC San Diego

Magna Cum Laude, GPA 3.94/4.0

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

- **Do Affirmative Action Bans Lower Minority College Enrollment and Graduation Share?** Difference-in-differences analysis of panel data from 763 four-year public institutions across 50 states (R, Stata).
- **Predicting Household Poverty in China:** Led a 2-person team applying geospatial and machine learning methods to household and satellite data (26,000+ households) across 260 counties.

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Technical: Python, R, SQL, Stata, Power BI, QGIS, Tableau

Certifications: Quantitative Certificate, Spatial Analysis Certificate, Policy Design and Evaluation Lab Certificate, Data Management 101, Intro to R, Intro to Python